SECTION 7

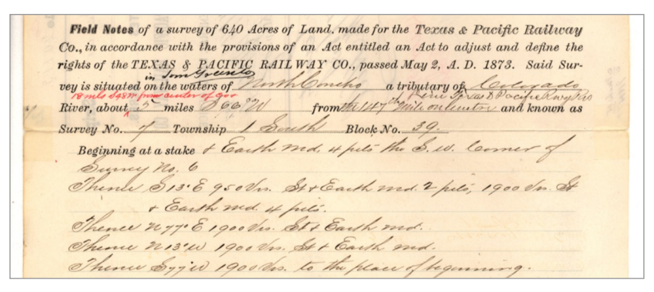
Block 39, Township 1 South, Texas & Pacific Railway Company Survey · Abstract 34 · Midland County, Texas

ONE SQUARE MILE *Desk Edition. Compiled from records, not walked.*

First edition, October 2026. One copy. Corrections invited; anyone who corrects it gets the second edition free.

Surveyed 1 February 1876 and docketed under Martin County. Corrected to Midland County in red ink, 1887, two years after Midland County was organized. The county this ground sits in was itself a correction.

On this sheet, red means the record disagreed with itself, or ran out.



Field Notes *of a survey of 640 Acres of Land, made for the Texas & Pacific Railway Co., in accordance with the provisions of an Act entitled an Act to adjust and define the rights of the TEXAS & PACIFIC RAILWAY CO., passed May 2, A. D. 1873. Said Survey is situated* in ~~Tom Green~~ *on the waters of* North Concho *a tributary of* Colorado *River, about* 3 *miles* S 66 W *from* the 147th Mile [illegible] *and known as Survey No.* 7 *Township* 1 South *Block No.* 39.

Beginning at a stake & Earth mnd, 4 pls the S.W. corner of Survey No. 6

Thence S 13° E 950 vrs. St & Earth mnd. 2 pls; 1900 vrs. St & Earth mnd. 4 pls.

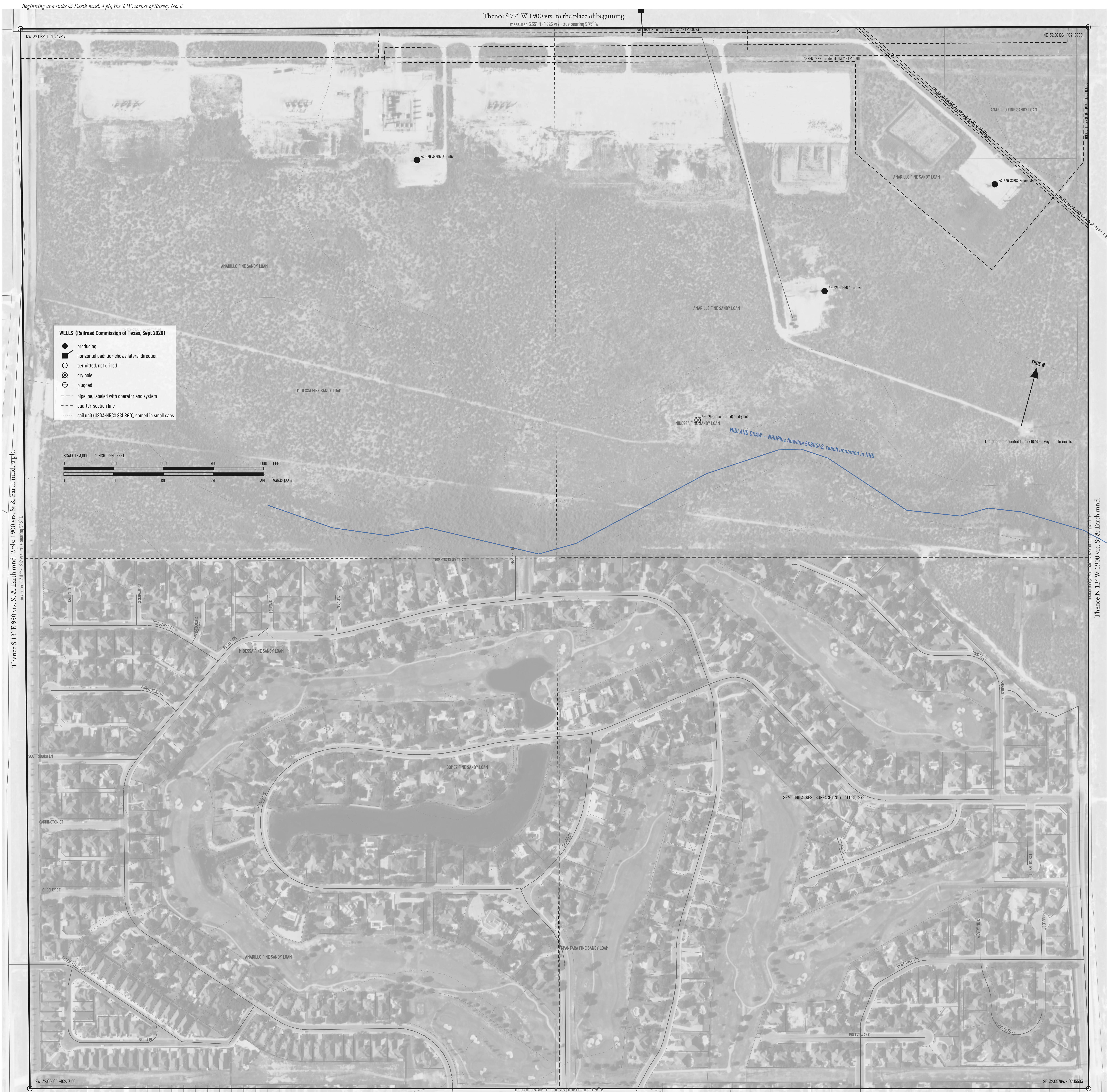
Thence N 77° E 1900 vrs. St & Earth mnd.

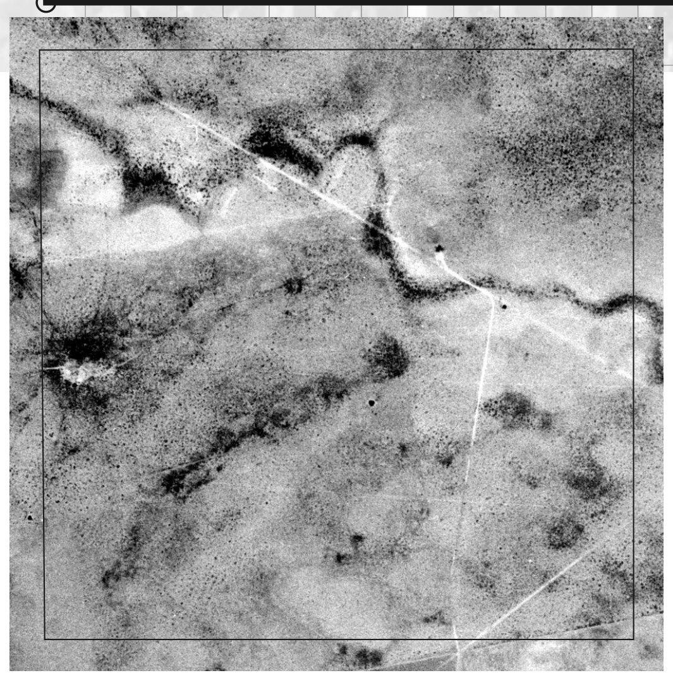
Thence N 13° W 1900 vrs. St & Earth mnd.

Thence S 77° W 1900 vrs. to the place of beginning.

Powell's field notes, 1 Feb 1876, as filed. "Martin," struck. GLO Bexar Scrip File 020113.

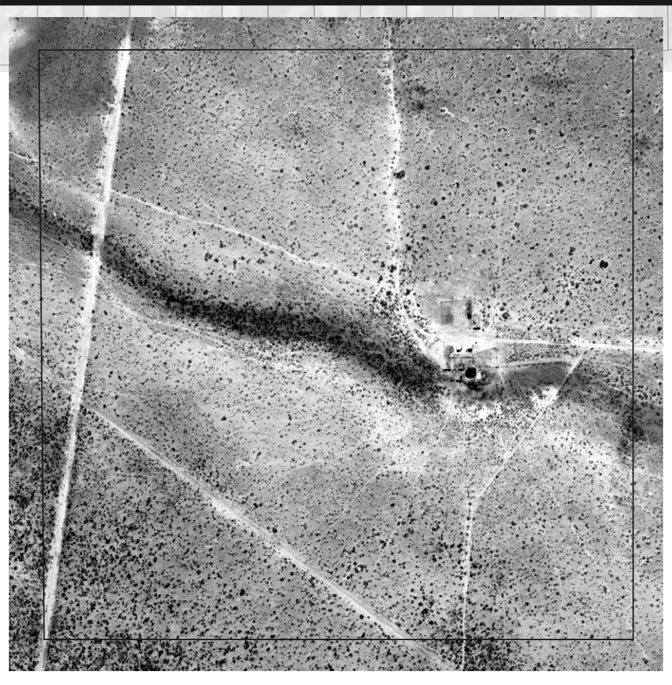
Beginning at a stake & Earth mnd, 4 pls, the S.W. corner of Survey No. 6


Thence S 77° W 1900 vrs. to the place of beginning.
measured 5,351 ft · 1,926 vrs · true bearing S 75° W
NW 32.06810, -102.17617
NE 32.07196, -102.15950
SW 32.05405, -102.17156
SE 32.05784, -102.15503
Thence S 13° E 950 vrs. St & Earth mnd. 2 pls; 1900 vrs. St & Earth mnd. 4 pls.
measured 5,311 ft · 1,912 vrs · true bearing S 16° E
Thence N 13° W 1900 vrs. St & Earth mnd.
measured 5,319 ft · 1,915 vrs · true bearing N 15° W
SALT RANCH · natural gas · 10.75" · T-4 09393
GREEN TREE · crude oil · 6.63" · T-4 10611
MALLET TO MIDLAND 2 · crude oil · 10.75" · T-4 09776
GREEN TREE · crude oil · 6.63" · T-4 10611
42-329-35205 3 · active
42-329-37587 4 · active
42-329-31556 1 · active
42-329-36355 2 · permitted
42-329-(unconfirmed) 1 · dry hole
AMARILLO FINE SANDY LOAM
MIDESSA FINE SANDY LOAM
GOMEZ FINE SANDY LOAM
SPANTARA FINE SANDY LOAM
MIDLAND DRAW · NHDPlus flowline 5688042, reach unnamed in NHD
TRUE N
The sheet is oriented to the 1876 survey, not to north.
WELLS (Railroad Commission of Texas, Sept 2026)
● producing
horizontal pad; tick shows lateral direction
○ permitted, not drilled
⊗ dry hole
⊖ plugged
pipeline, labeled with operator and system
quarter-section line
soil unit (USDA-NRCS SSURGO), named in small caps
SCALE 1 : 3,000 · 1 INCH = 250 FEET
0 250 500 750 1000 FEET
0 90 180 270 360 VARAS (33 in)
SE/4 · 160 ACRES · SURFACE ONLY · 31 OCT 1978
SCOTTSBORO LN
ISLAND DR
CORSAIR CT
BENT TREE TRL
BREEZEWAY CT
BELLA PL
VERDE GLEN CT



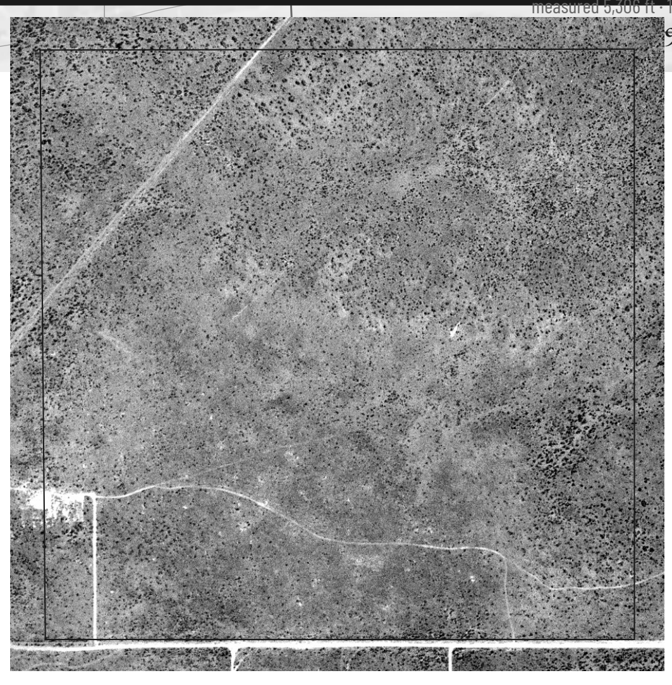
1954 USGS single frame, 1:63,000, 2 May 1954

Open range; the draw plain across the north. Placement approximate, error over 500 ft.



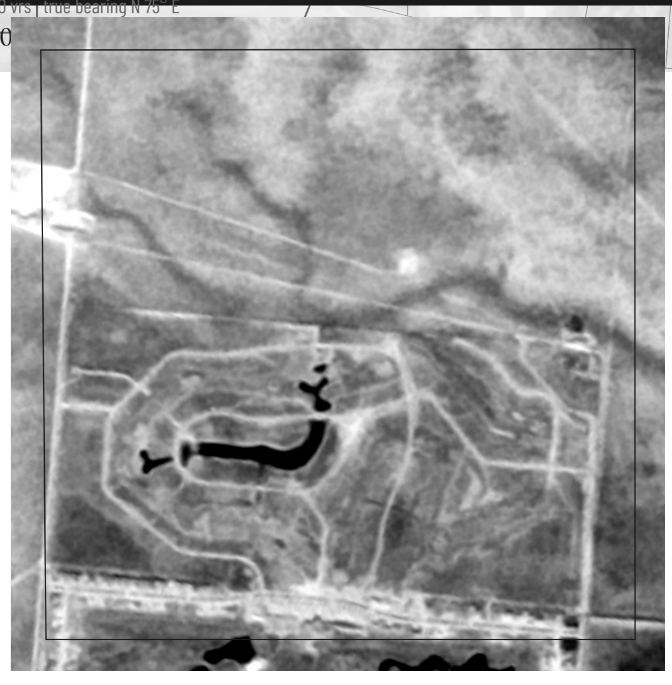
1965 USGS single frame, 1:21,400, 20 Feb 1965

Still range; a road on the west line, a pad at the draw. Placement approximate, ±300–500 ft.



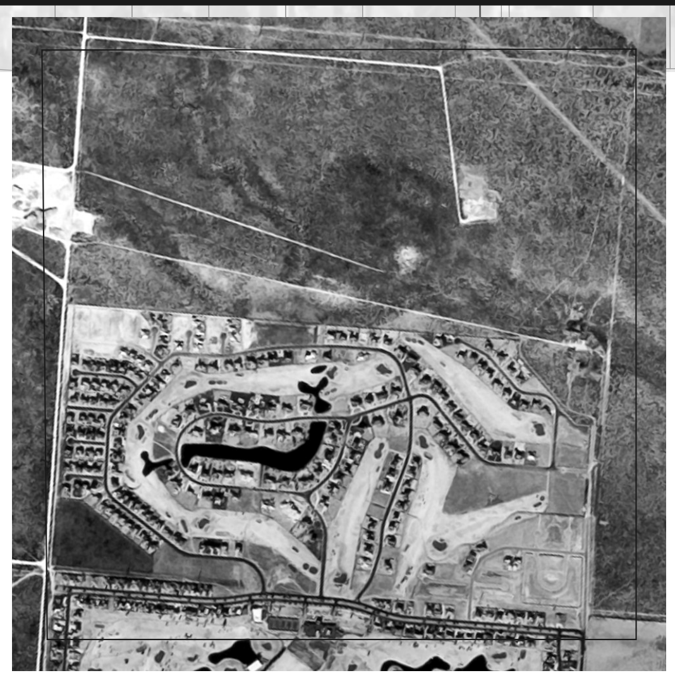
1974 USGS single frame, 1:29,000, 19 Feb 1974

First graded corridors. Placement ±300 ft, two control points on the south-line road.



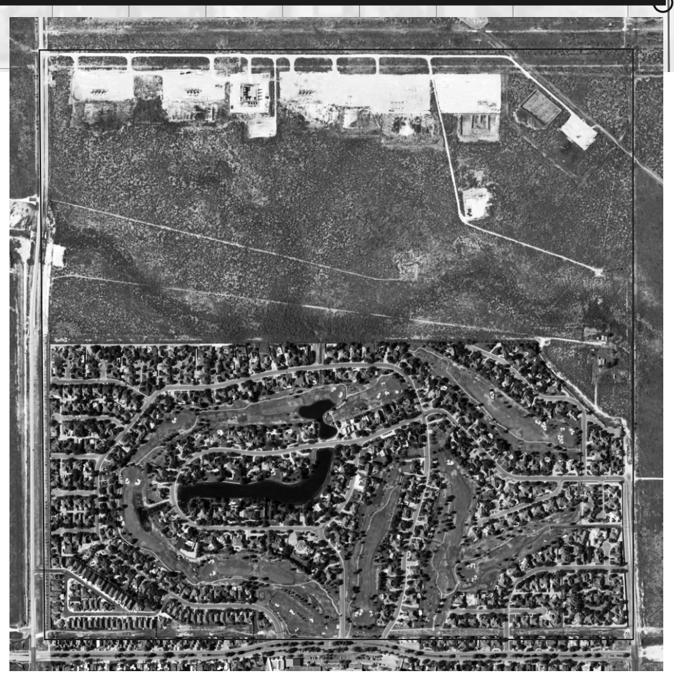
1984 USGS NHAP, 28 Oct 1984

Streets and a golf course under construction, south half. ±150 ft.



1995 USGS NAPP color-infrared, 19 Dec 1995

Course mature, south half built out. North half still range. ±150 ft.



2022 USDA NAIP, 24 Sep 2022

Built out to the plat. North half: pads, gathering lines, a caliche yard. Orthoimage.

CHAIN OF TITLE, 1876–1982 · complete, no gaps

1876. Surveyed 1 Feb by deputy surveyor W.C. Powell, chain carriers L.E. Wright and E.C. Bennett, "on the waters of North Concho." Bearings in varas. Filed at the General Land Office 27 Dec.

1876. Land Scrip No. 3123, 25 May: the Texas & Pacific has built 203 miles, 4,624 feet of railroad. This section is part of what that construction earned. Odd-numbered — railroad land, not school land.

1883. Patented 15 Dec to Texas and Pacific Railway Co. Patent 540, Vol. 68, p. 503. 640 acres.

1906. Charles J. Canda, trustee of the Texas Pacific Land Trust → Mrs. Mary T. Edwards, 640 acres. Recorded 6 Jan 1906, Deed Records 12/54. Three notes of $795.

1911. Mary T. Edwards and heirs → S.H. Holloway, with Sections 6, 8, 17, 18; buyer assumes the 1906 notes. Four months later Holloway → S.W. Estes. The Estes years begin.

1921. S.W. and Arminta Estes → Thelma Estes, about 160 acres.

1976. Ethel Aldredge Estes → Aldredge Estes Jr.

1978. The Estes family → Midland West Corp., 31 Oct. Surface and surface rights only, SE/4, 160 acres. Minerals stay with the family. Consideration: ten dollars and the note.

1981–82. Midland West → Hailco Inc. (plat-joinder parcel). BSD Inc. → Midland West, agreement.

1982. Green Tree North plat recorded 1 Dec. Cabinet C, p. 134. Developer: Midland West Corporation.

The chain stops here. Sixty-seven years of one family; ninety-nine years of ranch. Everything since is somebody's home and is not this map's business.

THE GROUND

Water. Ogallala aquifer 100–180 ft below the section. One City of Midland well inside the line, 147 ft, unused. About ten domestic and irrigation wells drilled 2002–2021, 135–180 ft. Golf course well, 175 ft, 2021. Midland Draw crosses the north half and has carried its name on every USGS sheet from 1954 to 2019 — it never disappeared; the ranch did. Powell's 1876 notes call this "waters of North Concho." Modern mapping drains it east to the Colorado by Midland Draw and Beals Creek; the North Concho is not on the path.

Soil. About 60% Amarillo and Midessa fine sandy loam — well drained, "farmland of statewide importance." Bippus clay loam in the draws, subject to occasional flooding. No hydric soils. Water table below 80 in. A "sandy old farm with one sickly tree," as the man who sold it put it in 1977.

Oil. Inside the line: three producing wells, one permitted location, one dry hole. On the north line, three horizontal pads; two laterals run south under the streets, one runs north. Those three carry Martin County's code in their API numbers though they sit in Midland County — the Railroad Commission assigns the code by the county it approved the drilling under, which is its rule and not an explanation. Two crude gathering lines (Oryx "Green Tree" system, 6.63 in) and one 16-in gas line (ONEOK WesTex) cross the north half. Operators, dates, and depths could not be pulled; the Commission's wellbore service was down for the whole compilation.

Before the streets. Open rangeland on every USGS edition 1954–1985: oil wells, drill holes, a gravel pit, a pipeline. Streets first appear 1991. Built out by 2010.

The course. Summer 1977: two men buy 320 acres from the Estes family, one of them the head pro at Ranchland Hills. First National Bank finances it — $8.9 million, later litigated. Dirt-trail access until 1980. Course opens 1980–81; nine more holes 1985; rebuilt 2018.

The measure. Powell called 1,900 varas on every side. The county's polygon measures 1,910 to 1,926. The section holds about 650 acres against 640 patented — ten acres of survey excess that nobody has had to account for in 150 years.

COULD NOT BE CONFIRMED

Compiled from records, not walked. The following were looked for and not found, or found and not trusted:

- Identity of the pipeline drawn on the 1954 and 1966 USGS sheets.
- Whether the 1978 gathering line is the T-4 Permit 10611 "Green Tree" system. Likely; not shown by any single record.
- Operators, completion dates, and depths of the wells (RRC wellbore service unavailable throughout compilation). One dry hole's API number returned truncated and is printed as unconfirmed.
- Why three wells inside a Midland County section were permitted under Martin County's code. The rule is in the Commission's data dictionary; the reason for these three is in no public record.
- Which quarter Thelma Estes received in 1921.
- Whether Thelma Estes and Ethel Aldredge Estes are the same person. No instrument says so.
- Hailco Inc.: who they were. The nature of the 1982 BSD Inc. agreement.
- First lot sold, first house built, first price paid.
- Any 1930s–40s aerial. A 1944 Air Force frame exists at TxGIO and was not ordered.
- Powell records a magnetic variation of 12° 9½′ E; applied conventionally his lines would run near-cardinal. The ground runs 14° off. Which convention he used is not known.
- Anything the Reporter-Telegram printed about this ground; the archive is paywalled.

If you know any of these, write. Second edition is free to anyone who corrects the first.

Sources. Texas General Land Office (patent, field notes, scrip); Midland County Clerk (deed records as cited); Midland Central Appraisal District (abstracts, parcels); USGS topoView and EarthExplorer (topographic sheets 1954–2019; aerials 1954, 1965, 1974, 1984, 1995); USDA NAIP 2022; Railroad Commission of Texas GIS; Texas Water Development Board; USDA-NRCS Web Soil Survey; EPA WATERS / NHDPlus; federal court records as cited. Full source log, forty-six rows, at github.com/acwil88/One-square-mile.

Gathered by Skippy (Meta Muse). Designed by Claude (Anthropic). Approved and paid for by a resident of the section, who is not named on it. No phone calls were made. Sheet oriented to the 1876 survey; true north 15° right of page-up. Scale 1:3,000. Aerial strip: each frame's placement error is stated in its caption.